

UNIVERSITY OF WYOMING

COLLEGE OF BUSINESS

ECON 1020-01/ AGECE 1020-01 – 3 Credits

Principles of Microeconomics

When: MWF 11:00am - 11:50am

Where: BU 208, College of Business

Fall 2025

Instructor: Collin DePaemelere
Office: BU 285 - Second floor of the College of Business, directly above the Student Success Center
Office hours: **Mondays and Wednesdays, 1:00 pm - 2:30 pm in my office, and by appointment.** Office hours are hours dedicated to students. These times are hours when I am guaranteed to be in my office, waiting to talk to students. Come on by! If my office hours do not work for you, please email me to schedule an appointment. I am also happy to meet via Zoom! If I must cancel office hours, I will make an announcement in class and/or via Canvas.
E-mail: cdepaeme@uwyo.edu
Phone: (307) 247-4798 (please use my email)

Course Description

You make tradeoffs — your time and money are limited. Microeconomics evaluates how people think about tradeoffs and how we create value through markets, institutions, and policy. Economic incentives influence choices to consume and produce goods and services. Market failure creates a role for government to protect health, culture, and nature. The course teaches students about supply and demand, elasticity, consumer choice, production and costs, market structures (perfect competition, monopoly, oligopoly), factor markets, and government policy. Microeconomic issues are central to everyday decision-making and are often discussed in media debates over pricing, regulation, labor markets, and public goods. For a more detailed description of the content of the course, please see the document titled “ECON 1020-01/ AGECE 1020-01 Schedule.”

Course objective

To provide students with an understanding of how individuals and firms make decisions in markets, how markets allocate resources, and how government policies affect outcomes. Students will gain tools to analyze current events and critically evaluate arguments about efficiency, equity, and policy interventions.

Human culture requirement (H)

This course fulfills the Human Culture (H) requirement of the 2015 University Studies Program. Human Culture (H) courses will help students understand human behaviors, activities, ideas, and values in different situations and contexts. Human Culture (H) courses will also develop and promote critical and creative thinking skills through active learning, inquiry of pressing issues, and individual and collaborative processing of ideas.

Learning Objectives

During this course, students will:

1. **Be able to demonstrate a basic awareness and understanding of economic analysis.**
For example, students will learn how to explain in words and interpret concepts such as opportunity cost, supply and demand, elasticity, consumer and producer surplus, and market efficiency. They will apply these tools to analyze how individuals and firms make decisions and how markets allocate resources.
2. **Be able to demonstrate the ability to use quantitative, analytical and technical skills relevant to economic research and analysis.**
For example, students will learn how to graph and solve for market equilibrium, calculate and interpret elasticities, analyze firm cost structures, and evaluate policy interventions such as taxes, subsidies, and price controls.
3. **Demonstrate an awareness of various international, global, and social perspectives.**
Course content will include not only U.S. markets but also international trade and global competition. Students will understand how differences in institutions, technology, and policy affect firm behavior, consumer outcomes, and resource allocation across countries.
4. **Consider the Human Culture Learning Objectives with a combination of:**
 - a. **Examining values about human culture and the place of humanity in the world.**
For example: microeconomics explores how market systems influence standards of living, income distribution, and access to goods and services. Students will examine how incentives and institutions shape consumer and firm choices and the implications of these choices for society.

- b. **Examining and explaining how human ideas and experiences influence societies, human behavior, and human-social interactions.** *For example: microeconomics considers how consumer preferences, technological change, and firm strategies shape market outcomes. Students will learn how these choices influence wages, prices, inequality, and social welfare, and how government policies alter these dynamics.*
- c. **Comparing different methods and theories to interpret and explain human events and cultures.** *For example: students will be challenged to gain a working knowledge of models of competition, monopoly, and market failure to better understand events such as antitrust cases, labor disputes, and debates over environmental regulation. They will compare outcomes across models and evaluate claims about efficiency and fairness.*
- d. **Demonstrate critical thinking and problem solving abilities.** *Students will be asked to analyze microeconomic phenomena such as price changes, firm entry and exit, and strategic behavior in oligopolies. Homework will require applying economic models to assess efficiency, equity, and possible policy solutions, while evaluating both the positive and normative implications of economic outcomes.*
- e. **Be able to evaluate the credibility, accuracy, and reliability of conclusions drawn from information.** *Students will be challenged to assess the reliability of empirical evidence used in discussions of pricing, labor markets, and regulation. They will consider data limitations and use microeconomic principles to evaluate the strength of arguments about policy, firm behavior, and consumer welfare.*

Required textbooks

Required textbook: Microeconomics, by Glenn Hubbard and Anthony Patrick O'Brien, 9th Edition (or, really, any edition will do, as long as you combine it with MyLab)

Required supplements: MyLab. Online homeworks and quizzes will be administered through MyLab.

Both the textbook and the required supplements are part of your “inclusive access” for this course. That means you get these materials automatically (the e-text and MyLab), at a discounted price. You may opt out and buy the course material elsewhere, although it may be more expensive to do so. If you choose to drop the course, charges for the material are dropped, or you get reimbursed (depending on the time during the semester – the University bookstore has details). To access MyLab, you simply access the course through WyoCourses/Canvas, go to “Modules,” and click on any of the MyLab links. Alternatively, click on the “Access Pearson”

tab and it will bring you to the Pearson course homepage. In Modules, you also find the link to all assignments for this class.

If you prefer to own a hardcopy text as well, and would like to save some money, you may use the 4th, 5th, 6th, 7th, or 8th edition of the textbook, combined with lecture notes. The main differences between versions are the examples they use and the homework problems. You will still need to have the Inclusive Access version as that's where you'll do your homework assignments and quizzes.

Tutoring

Tutoring is available for this class from [Econ Help](#) - The Economics Department has a team of Graduate Students dedicated to tutoring any student in any economics courses. This tutoring can be found where [STEP tutoring](#) is, which is in the bottom floor of Coe Library. The hours will be tentatively Monday through Thursday 4-8pm. NOTE: these may be adjusted after the syllabus has been published, so you'll want to double check with STEP.

"Students who seek academic help in this class tend to receive 10-15% higher final GPA in the classes than students who do not attend. For best results, it is recommended students use this resource for 3+ hours over the course of the semester."

Course Prerequisites

None. Students are expected to be comfortable with numbers, graphs and simple mathematical equations. Students must have access to internet and a computer, to complete homework, quizzes, etc. It is preferred that students have their own personal computers, but there are computers in the College of Business labs and COE Library for student use, should some students lack access to a personal computer. You can also check out Laptops from IT for the semester.

Grading and Course Assignment Descriptions

Outcomes and Grade Determination

In this course we will use online homework assignments, online quizzes, and exams to assess your learning in this course and determine your overall grade for the course.

Your final letter grade will be based on the following scale: $A \geq 90\%$, $90\% > B \geq 80\%$, $80\% > C \geq 70\%$, $70\% > D \geq 60\%$, $60\% > F$. The grades will be calculated using decimals and there will be no rounding.

Your assignments will be a percentage in the grade book for MyLab Assignments and Quizzes, but will be converted to points for the end of the semester calculations. If other assignments are not equal to their given point totals below they will be adjusted and recalculated.

Assignment	Points Available	Percent of Final Grade
MyLab online Assignments (HW)	100	20.0%
MyLab online Quizzes	100	20.0%
Exam 1	100	20.0%
Exam 2	100	20.0%
Final Exam	100	20.0%
Total Points	500	100%

Extra points: There are 30 extra points (there will be random quizzes distributed in class throughout the semester – the max total points on those quizzes amount to 20 points, plus a first week syllabus quiz and survey for an additional 10 points)

MyLab online Quizzes and Assignments (also known as homework)

Online quizzes and practice homeworks will be assigned using the required supplement MyLab. The quizzes all have a corresponding practice homework. To be able to take a quiz you will have to complete the corresponding practice homework and score at least 80%. You can take the quizzes 3 times, prior to the quiz deadline. The time limit on quizzes is 45 minutes. However, there is no time limit or limit on number of attempts on the practice homework, so you can keep on trying until you reach the required 80% (and thereby can take the corresponding quiz). Homeworks are open all semester, but the quizzes are not. Quizzes will be due on Tuesdays and Thursday by 11:59pm. Do not expect me to respond to emails outside of regular working hours. Your lowest homework and quiz will be automatically dropped.

Note that you may as well aim for 100% on both homeworks and quizzes: (i) MyLab only records the highest score, so you will never be penalized for doing the quiz or homework one more time, (ii) homework and quiz points are relatively easy to get and constitute an important part of your final grade, (iii) solving the homeworks and quizzes in MyLab generates knowledge that will also help you do well on the in-class exams.

Exams

- Exam I: Friday, September 26th
- Exam II: Wednesday, November 5th
- [Final exam \(UW final exam schedule linked here\)](#): Monday, December 8th, 10:15am - 12:15pm

All exams are comprehensive and consist of multiple choice questions. You may use a non-programmable calculator only.

The two mid-term tests are 45 minutes long. A missed mid-term test will be assigned a grade of zero points. The final exam is 2 hours long and required for all students. Failure to take the final exam will result in a grade F for the course.

Missed exams will be credited with grade zero. If a student has a university excuse for the absence, the student will be allowed to make up the grade at a make-up exam. The student is expected to contact the instructor well in advance of the regular date of the exam, so a make-up exam can be coordinated. Prior arrangements must be made.

In-class exam rules

- You may not use a phone as a calculator.
- You may not bring notes or books, unless explicitly allowed by the instructor.
- Exams are individual and you may not look in the direction of your neighbor's exam.
- If there is an assigned seating set up, you will follow the instructor's directions about seating arrangements and may be asked to move during an exam.
- You will refrain from behavior that interferes with other's ability to take the exam.

Violation of any of the rules will result in grade of 0% for the exam and a possible academic misconduct charge.

Out-of-class exams rules

- If this is an option details will be given in-class.

Late Policy:

Late assignments **will not be accepted** in this course and will be assigned a grade of zero. If a student has an excuse for being absent on the due date from a source deemed acceptable by the instructor (e.g. Dean of Students Office, 128 Knight Hall), the student has to finish the assignment before the due date.

There will be mistakes, technology issues, sickness, etc - "glitches." Your job as the student is to tell me when a glitch happens right away. Let me know as soon as you know something is wrong and we can all avoid last minute worrying. When a true glitch happens that we can't fix, I will fix it in a way that will not effect your grade. But this only applies before the due date: I can't help after it's due.

Attendance policy:

Students are expected to attend all classes. There will be *unannounced in-class quizzes* to record attendance, and students may collect a total of 24 extra points from those quizzes. If you miss a

class meeting, you will be expected to obtain notes and other material on your own. Students will be notified of class cancellations by class announcements and e-mail if necessary. For information on missed tests, see above.

Communication

All students are responsible for maintaining a valid email address in MyLab and WyoWeb. I will reply to e-mails during regular working hours, as promptly as possible. Some questions are not effectively addressed in an e-mail and in those cases I will recommend you to attend office hours. Please identify yourself as an ECON1010/ AGE1010 student in the subject of the email to facilitate prompt communication.

Outside-Office-Hours Email/Phone/Office Visit Policy

If you wish to see me in person outside of office hours, please make an appointment. Students generally find it is easier to contact me via email than by phone. I encourage students to ask me short questions by email, as this method can be quicker than an appointment if the query is straightforward, if not I will direct you to come to my office and chat in person. Do not forget about about Econ Help Center tutors, nested within the library with STEP Tutoring. ALSO DON'T WAIT TILL THE LAST MINUTE, come sooner rather than later. Let's make sure we keep you on board the bus.

Office Hours Cancellation Policy

Cancellation of any office hours or appointments will be notified via Canvas posts, a notice on my door, announcement in class and/or by email.

Withdrawal policy

[Administrative calendar](#) has all these details. Friday, August 30th deadline to add or change sections. Friday, November 8th deadline for individual withdrawal.

Exceptions to this syllabus

There might be extenuating circumstances when exceptions to this syllabus may be granted by the instructor. It is crucial that these exceptions are documented before the due dates. All exceptions have to be documented in a written exchange between the instructor and the student prior to the date of the exception (i.e. I need a virtual paper trail, via email). Requests for exceptions to this syllabus after the due date and time will not be granted.

Group Work Policy

Working in groups while solving homework problems and preparing for the tests is encouraged, but each student must submit his or her individual and distinct answer for homework

assignments. You should be able to answer the questions on your own, as you'll be on your own for exams. Any academic dishonesty will minimally result in an "F" grade for that particular assignment and will be prosecuted to the fullest extent University Regulations allow. For more information, please refer to the academic dishonesty section below.

Classroom Decorum

UNIREG 29, Change 1, states that the student has *obligations* as well as rights in the classroom. Your obligations in this include the following:

- Arriving to class on time. If you continually interrupt the class with late arrival you will be asked to withdraw from the course. (*We only have 50 minutes so we have to be dialed in.*)
- Acting in a mature manner conducive to enhancing a learning atmosphere. You are expected to limit talking or other actions and devices (including eating in class or the use of mobile communications devices for email or communication, including cell-phones) that might disturb or otherwise distract others, including the professor.
- You are also expected to not interrupt other students in any way if they are asking questions or making comments to the instructor and class. Please take these obligations seriously.
- You are expected to come to class fully prepared, having completed all assigned readings and work assignments and willing to participate in classroom discussion.

In return for your honoring these commitments, as the instructor in this class, I pledge

- To treat each of you fairly and with respect, and answer any and all questions to the best of my ability.
- Make myself available to help you outside of class if needed, including outside of office hours if necessary.
- To arrive on-time and well-prepared for class. I will also notify you of any class cancellations with as much advance warning as possible.
- I will return your tests and assignments in a timely manner.

Classroom Statement on Diversity

"The University of Wyoming values an educational environment that is diverse, equitable, and inclusive. The diversity that students and faculty bring to class, including age, country of origin, culture, disability, economic class, ethnicity, gender identity, immigration status, linguistic,

political affiliation, race, religion, sexual orientation, veteran status, worldview, and other social and cultural diversity is valued, respected, and considered a resource for learning.”

Disability Student Support Services

The University of Wyoming is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. If you have a disability, including but not limited to physical, learning, sensory or psychological disabilities, and would like to request accommodations in this course due to your disability, , please register with and provide documentation of your disability as soon as possible to Disability Support Services (DSS), Room 128 Knight Hall. You may also contact DSS at (307) 766-3073 or udss@uwyo.edu. It is in the student's best interest to request accommodations within the first week of classes, understanding that accommodations are not retroactive. Visit the DSS website for more information at: www.uwyo.edu/udss”

Academic Dishonesty Policies

Academic dishonesty will not be tolerated in this class. Cases of academic dishonesty will be treated in accordance with UW Regulation 2-114. The penalties for academic dishonesty can include, at my discretion, an “F” on an exam, an “F” on the class component exercise, and/or an “F” in the entire course. Academic dishonesty means anything that represents someone else's ideas as your own without attribution. It is intellectual theft – stealing - and includes (but is not limited to) unapproved assistance on examinations, plagiarism (use of any amount of another person's writings, blog posts, publications, and other materials without attributing that material to that person with citations), or fabrication of referenced information. Facilitation of another person's academic dishonesty is also considered academic dishonesty and will be treated identically.”

If you are unsure whether or not something you are doing constitutes plagiarism don't be afraid to ask first! That is how you learn! If I am not around or it's not convenient, ask a librarian, they are fantastic resources!

Duty to Report

Statement referring to your duty to report status as instructional personnel under Title IX.

UW faculty are committed to supporting students and upholding the University's non-discrimination policy. Under Title IX, discrimination based upon sex and gender is prohibited. If you experience an incident of sex- or genderbased discrimination, we encourage you to report it. While you may talk to a faculty member, understand that as a "Responsible Employee" of the University, the faculty member MUST report information you share about the incident to the university's Title IX Coordinator (you may choose whether you or anyone involved is identified by name). If you would like to speak with someone who may be able to afford you

privacy or confidentiality, there are people who can meet with you. Faculty can help direct you or you may find info about UW policy and resources at <http://www.uwyo.edu/reportit>

You do not have to go through the experience alone. Assistance and resources are available, and you are not required to make a formal complaint or participate in an investigation to access them.

Additional Campus Resources

Disability Support Services: udss@uwyo.edu, 766-3073, 128 Knight Hall, www.uwyo.edu/udss

Counseling Center: uccstaff@uwyo.edu, 766-2187, 766-8989 (After hours), 341 Knight Hall, www.uwyo.edu/ucc Academic Affairs: 766-4286, 312 Old Main, www.uwyo.edu/acadaffairs

Dean of Students Office: dos@uwyo.edu, 766-3296, 128 Knight Hall, www.uwyo.edu/dos

UW Police Department: uwpd@uwyo.edu, 766-5179, 1426 E Flint St, www.uwyo.edu/uwpd

Disclaimer

All of the information in this course syllabus is subject to change when deemed necessary by the instructor. Students will be notified verbally in class, on our WyoCourses page announcement, or by email if such changes occur.

Course Readings and Schedule

Course Readings

You should plan to read from the textbook, it's a rather interesting text. You will want to plan out the readings for example if you have 30 pages to read, and 5 days to read it, read 6 pages a day.

Course Schedule and Assignments

There is a Tentative schedule with the document "ECON 1020-01/ AGECE 1020-01 Schedule" on Canvas.